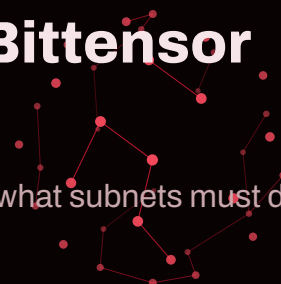


SUBNE MAGAZINE

OP-ED · Issue 007, The accessibility gap

The Inaccessibility Problem of the Bittensor Ecosystem

Why Bittensor's habit of writing only for developers locks out retail, and what subnets must do to compete in the attention economy.



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2025-09-22 · filed by Laron Campbell

Ecosystem Why Bittensor's habit of writing only for developers locks out retail, and what subnets must do to compete in the attention economy. 2025-09-22 · filed by Laron Campbell

Bittensor Ecosystem

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One of the biggest issues plaguing the FBittensor ecosystem as a whole is that founders and builders suffer from communication misalignment, a misunderstanding of how to communicate and market their product to both the developer community and retail, who are both potential investors and users of their product.

The overcomplication of product updates, mission statements, and white papers aims to speak to only one class of user, the developer, locking out retail and “normies” from understanding what is going on and why it is important in layman terms.

In the crypto space, where AI and blockchain merging is a novel concept, most retail users are still getting comfortable with basics like using a DEX, trading memecoins, or reading on-chain data. They're often new to crypto investing altogether.

From my experience, people invest in projects that excite them, ones they can easily understand, and ecosystems that foster a sense of community and growth.

This is why memecoins (and at one point, NFTs) have gained such popularity. They've lowered barriers to entry, allowing blockchains like @solana and @ethereum to flourish in the attention economy. Many dApps on these platforms excel at speaking to both developers and retail investors by simplifying concepts and

making learning fun, just look at their homepages for examples. In contrast, Bittensor subnets often feel ten times more complex. This isn't solely due to the intricacies of machine learning (ML), technical benchmarks, or reinforcement learning (RL). Most times, this comes across as pure intellectual posturing. Writing for retail would do more to promote your project than writing for a few experts.

If the argument is to advertise technicals for institutional adoption, there's no merit. After all, @solana and @ethereum have far greater institutional presence, so that argument doesn't hold. In my view, the root lies in a

developer culture that may lack familiarity with mainstream crypto psychology and community dynamics.

I've also seen a shortage of user-friendly wallets with intuitive UIs, ease of use, and strong marketability. The ecosystem's technical focus makes it hard to navigate, with communities often fragmented and centered on miners and validators rather than broader engagement.

That's why Subnet Discords are seen as spaces for technical discussion, rather than community building and galvanizing around a particular project. Also a reason why alpha token prices rises and falls are dependent solely on developer updates and roll outs, rather than organic, organized excitement generation.

It's an ecosystem-wide issue, from the Opentensor Foundation (@opentensor) to individual subnets, though some like @ridges_ai stand out.

Shakeel Hussain, (@hobbleabbas), the developer behind @ridges_ai, impresses me with his ability to explain core concepts in accessible ways. Whether due to his background as a former trader or his youthful perspective, he engages both experts and newcomers effectively. He writes about the same concepts other subnets find so hard to explain.

This approach pays dividends in ways that transcends fundamentals of a product.

Bittensor has the most promising fundamentals in the space that hold it up really well, but its barrier to entry is truly hampering its progress in the attention economy community building arena. However, there are some ecosystem participants that are striving to help bridge this gap, like FTAOTemplar, FTheTaoPod, @taostats, FReadBong0, FAltcoinMillie, FRaleigh_CA, @markjeffrey, @venturalabs, FBarrySilbert, @jaltucher, and FJosephJacks_and a few others.

However, some may come across as promoting specific tokens rather than advancing the ecosystem holistically, unlike evangelists in @solana, @ethereum, and early @bitcoin.

As Bittensor remains inaccessible to everyday crypto users, I encourage subnet owners and the Opentensor Foundation (@opentensor) to prioritize retail onboarding. Explain projects in terms that even the least initiated can understand, this is essential for a thriving ecosystem. Create videos, publish tutorials, make it easy to join the ecosystem and engage with subnets right out the gate. We need to make AI cool again. Think of FBitcoinMagazine and Bitcoin maxis as early evangelists before mainstream adoption.

Subnets should pitch themselves externally. The community's already onboard.

For example, I look to a day where @sportstensor is retweeting NFL highlights or joking about parlays. Similarly, @zeussubnet could connect with meteorologists and climate activists. A good example of a subnet working to bring on its own niche community is FMetaNOVA_labs, speaking directly to bioinformaticians and deSci communities with their posts.

If subnets pitched their projects directly to the wider communities they are trying to disrupt, bringing them over to the side of crypto we see, where technology is used for the greater good, it would speak more readily to the open source values that Bittensor was founded on.

This culture of overly-complicated technical updates, one that speaks only to developers and software engineers contradicts crypto's core ethos. Bitcoin, at its outset, and crypto as a whole, were meant to be the great equalizer. Crypto is meant to be the path for those who do not have access to wealth outside of the systems and structures built to disenfranchise them.

When we make the barriers to enter so high, we are going against the very fundamentals upon which Bitcoin and crypto were founded.

Bittensor is set up to do well, we as a community just have to work together to get it there.

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Simplifying Bittensor subnet ecosystem through accessible, insightful articles. #TAO